

Chair and Blade: job, page structure and look

<https://www.chairandblade.co.uk/>

Tracked as CRO-27. Live site looked at on 2026-09-29.

What this is

A worksheet for deciding how this client's public site should work and look, and why. It replaces the earlier decision PDF, whose recommendations rested on evidence that did not hold up. It recommends nothing. Everything under 'What is on the site today' is what was visible in screenshots, described by eye.

What is different this time

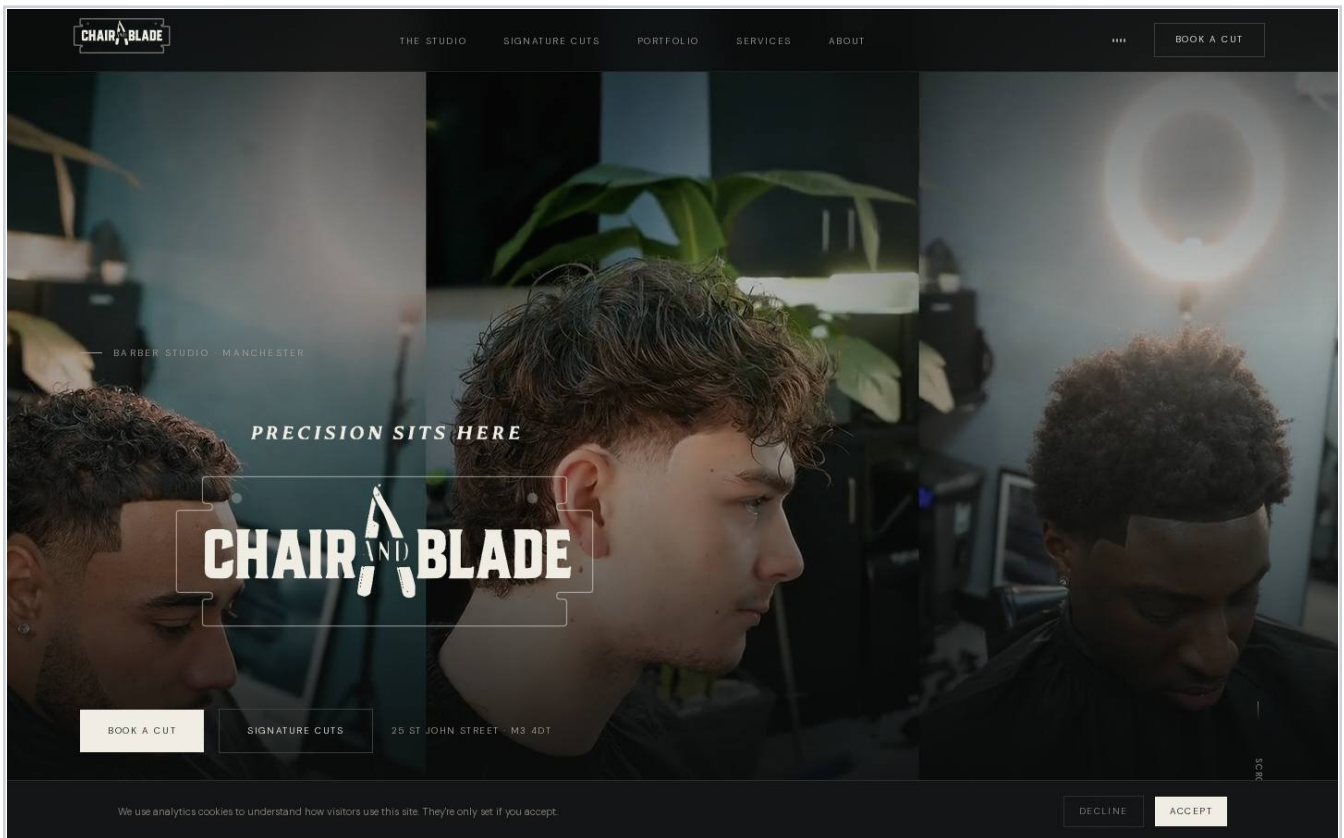
- Three steps, in this order: the job (who is visiting and what they need), the page structure (what leads, where the main action sits), then the seven looks.
- The page layout is now part of the decision. The old rule that section order and button positions must not move is withdrawn (craft CHARACTER.md, 26 September). Keeping the current layout is fine, but it needs a reason too.
- Every reason is in your own words and is about this client's customer. 'Industry standard', 'best practice', 'visitors expect it', 'it looks professional' and 'it is familiar' do not count as reasons.
- Do not look at what other businesses in the same trade do. Take evidence from this client's customers: reviews, enquiries, conversations, what people search for.
- An option must come from something the client has: the logo, premises, paperwork, their trade or their customers. Anything can change, nothing is kept just because it is there.

How to fill it in

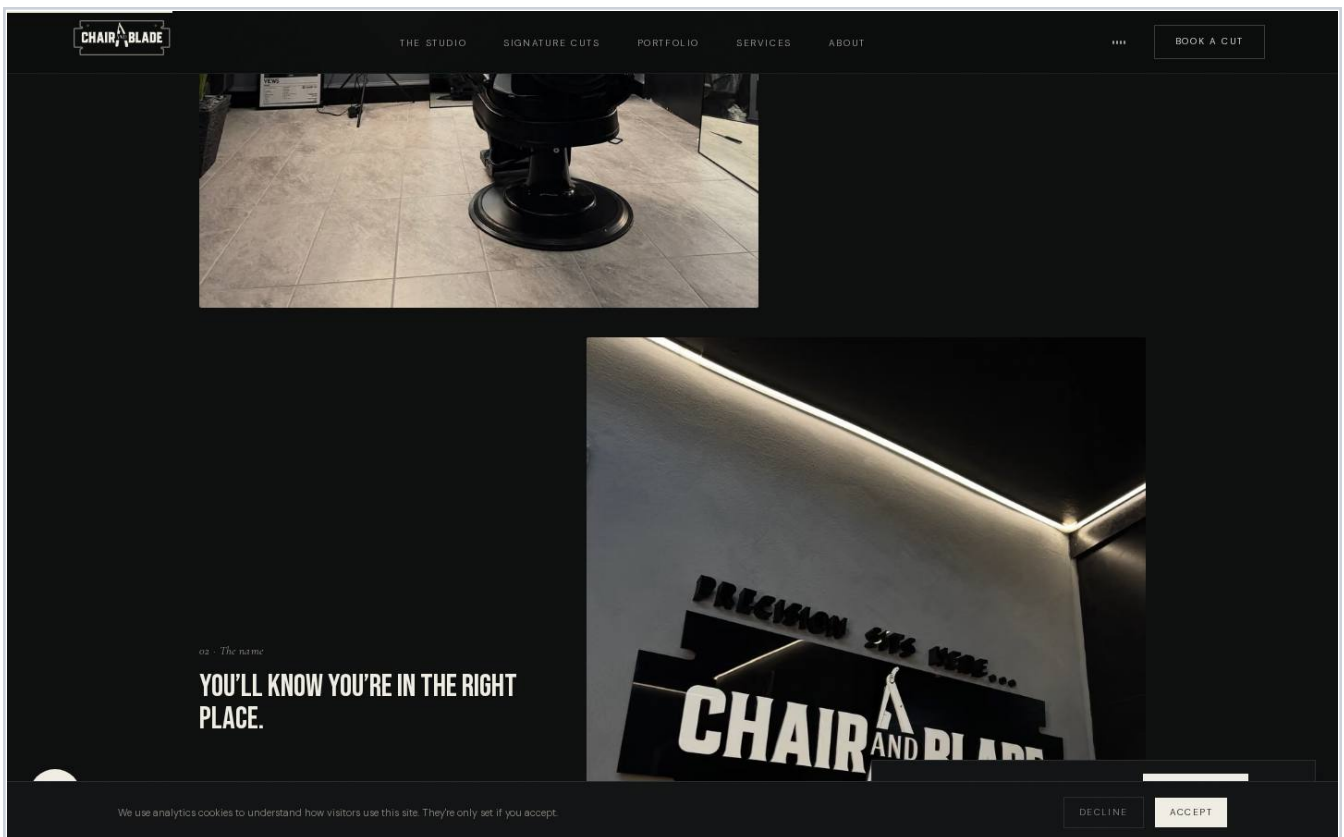
- Open in Preview on a Mac, or the Files app on an iPhone. Type into the boxes and tick the tick boxes.
- Where the site shows something marked 'to check', do not treat it as true until it is checked.
- Save the filled copy, attach it to the same Linear issue and move the issue to Done.
- It counts as decided when the job is written, every page listed in Part 2 has all four answers, and at least five of the seven looks have a choice and a reason.

What the live site looked like

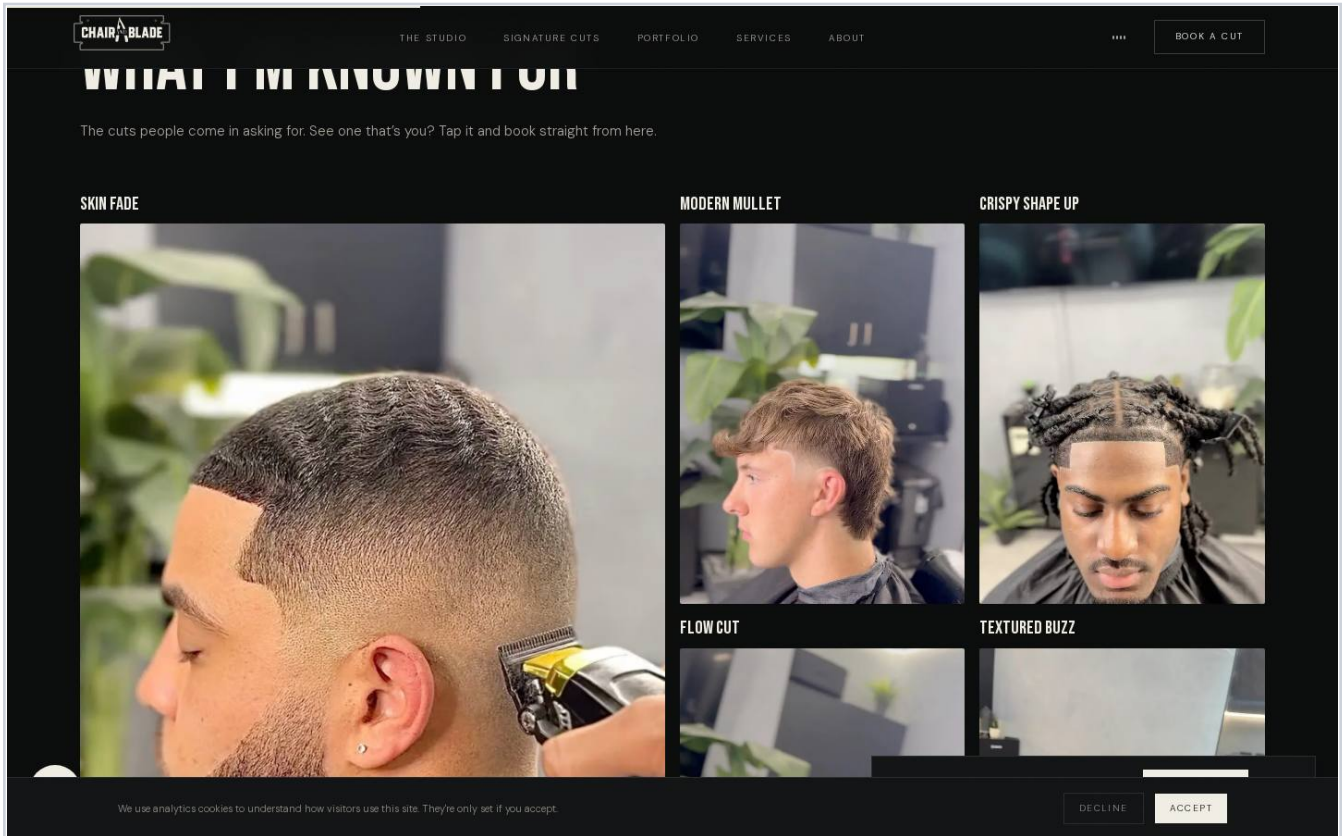
Screenshots taken by machine and looked at by eye. The cookie banner was left as found; nothing was clicked or submitted.



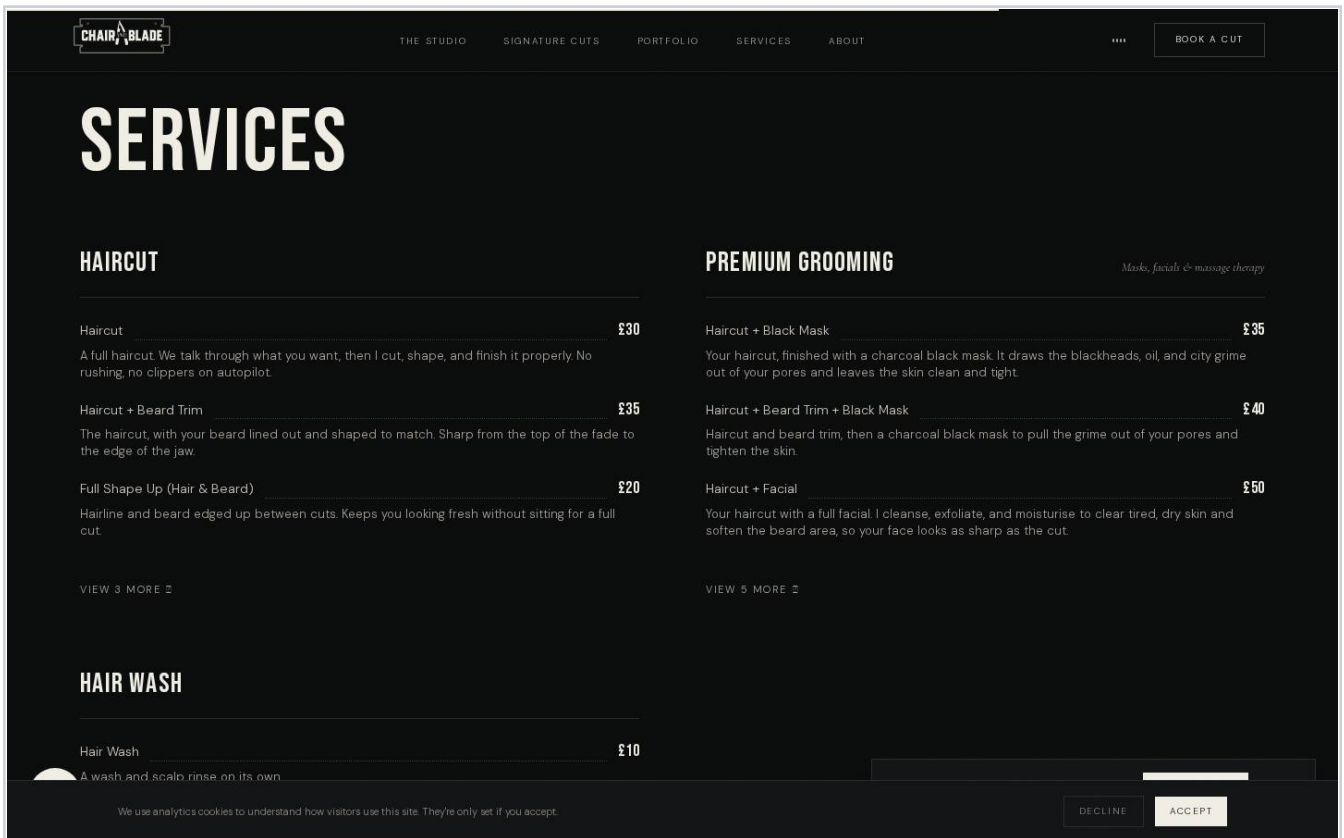
Home, first screen (desktop)



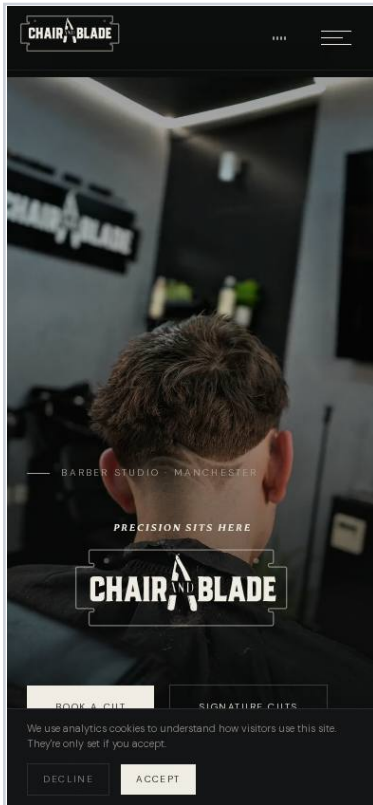
Home, the studio (desktop)



Home, signature cuts (desktop)



Home, services and prices (desktop)



Home, first screen (mobile)

What is on the site today

Pages looked at: Home (one very long page, looked at from top to footer).

- The logo is CHAIR AND BLADE in a heavy condensed capital face, with a razor-blade outline around it and a razor forming the A.
- The whole page is near-black with off-white text. There is no accent colour: the only contrast is cream against black.
- Headings are tall condensed capitals; small labels are wide-spaced capitals; a delicate italic serif is used for asides (PRECISION SITS HERE, It's in the Fades., 01 · The chair).
- Corners are square. Buttons are either a cream block or a thin outlined box. Portfolio photos have a very slight rounding.
- The first screen is a three-panel strip of clients mid-cut in the studio, with the logo lockup laid over it and two buttons (Book a cut, Signature cuts) and the address.
- A scrolling ticker sits under the hero: St John Street Manchester, Skin fades and tapers, Appointments only, Textured cuts, Barber to the cast of Hamilton, Precision sits here.
- Come have a look shows the studio itself: lit ceiling strips, the chair, a wall sign with the logo, a ring light, plants. Signature cuts is a named grid (Skin fade, Modern mullet, Crispy shape up, Flow cut and more), then a Portfolio strip linking to Instagram.
- The page is one long scroll (about 15,800 pixels on desktop). The menu (The Studio, Signature Cuts, Portfolio, Services, About) jumps within it. In order it runs: first-screen strip, ticker, the studio, a one-line quote, signature cuts, a wall of portfolio photos linking to Instagram, reviews, services and prices, a FAQ, the barber, the footer.
- Services is a two-column price list with dotted leaders: Haircut 30 pounds, Haircut and Beard Trim 35, Full Shape Up 20; Premium Grooming with a black mask 35, with beard trim 40, with facial 50; Hair Wash 10. Each column has a View more link.
- The FAQ (Before you book) is a list of collapsed questions: how long a haircut takes, washing your hair first, not knowing what style you want, walk-ins.
- The About section is one barber, Emmanuel, with a portrait and short points (official barber for the cast of Hamilton the Musical, London School of Barbering graduate, specialist in skin fades, tapers and textured cuts, educator and mentor) and a Book with Emmanuel button.
- The footer gives the address (25 St John Street, Manchester M3 4DT), a phone number to call on arrival, appointments only, on-site parking, Get directions, a Show map box that says it loads from Google, and Instagram and TikTok links.

To check before relying on any of it

- Large empty stretches on the screens may be scroll reveals that had not fired. A band of flat taupe about 135 pixels tall sits above the FAQ; cause unknown.
- The reviews section heading was seen, but the review text itself was not visible in the screens taken, so nothing can be said about the reviews.
- Small boxed characters appear before each ticker item and after View more. They may be missing symbols in the capture browser rather than a fault on the site.
- The Hamilton claim appears in the ticker and in the barber's section. It is a client claim and needs the client's confirmation.
- No booking form was seen; Book a cut and Book with Emmanuel go somewhere not followed here.
- The cookie bar was left open along the bottom.

Screenshots taken with scripts/visual/capture.mjs and looked at by eye. Descriptions say what was visible on the screen. Font names, hex codes and image ownership were not read from code and are not claimed.

Part 1: the job

Who visits this site and what are they trying to get done? Write about the customer, not about the business or its competitors. Use what you know from real reviews, enquiries and conversations.

Who visits, and what has just happened to make them look?

They want to ...

an action word (find, book, decide, check, get, arrange ...)

what they want to get done. Not 'a trade website' or the trade itself

in what situation, under what pressure (today, cheaply, without being talked down to ...)

What has to get done (the practical need)

How they want to feel by the end

How long do they take to decide?

☐ Low: minutes or a day ☐ Considered: days ☐ High: weeks or months

Why that speed (from what customers actually do)

Part 1: the job (continued)

Who do they have to explain or justify the choice to, and what would make them look good or bad?

What worries them before getting in touch? What has gone wrong for them or people they know?

Their own words for the problem and for what they want. Exact quotes, one per line

Where each of those came from (a review, an enquiry, a conversation, a search). Names and dates, not links to other businesses' sites

Part 2: page structure, Home

Decide what this page is for, what leads, and what order it runs in. Keeping today's order is allowed, with a reason.

Page

Home

The one main action a visitor should take on this page (for example: call now, book, send an enquiry)

Where the main action sits (tick all that apply)

- ☐ Header ☐ First screen ☐ After proof or reviews ☐ Middle of page ☐ Bottom of page
☐ Stays on screen

Why it sits there. Say how fast the customer decides, or which worry it answers

The order the sections should run, top to bottom, one per line, each with a few words on why

Section names craft understands: hero, logos, stats, cards, marquee, text, other, cta-band, footer-cta, pricing, testimonials, faq, process, features, team, contact.

What leads (the one thing seen first) and what is deliberately smaller

Part 3: look 1 of 7, Display face

The typeface for headlines.

On the site today (seen by eye)

Heavy condensed capitals

Your decision

☐

Keep what is there

☐

Change it

What it should be

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 2 of 7, Body face

The typeface for text, buttons and forms.

On the site today (seen by eye)

Plain wide-set sans; italic serif for asides

Your decision

☐

Keep what is there

☐

Change it

What it should be

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 3 of 7, Accent colour

The one colour that means 'press this'.

On the site today (seen by eye)

None: cream on black

Your decision

☐

Keep what is there

☐

Change it

What it should be. A colour name, or a hex code taken from something the client has

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 4 of 7, Ground

The page colour.

On the site today (seen by eye)

Near-black throughout

Your decision

☐

Keep what is there

☐

Change it

What it should be. A colour name, or a hex code taken from something the client has

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 5 of 7, Shape

How corners and edges look.

On the site today (seen by eye)

Square corners, thin outlined buttons

Your decision

☐

Keep what is there

☐

Change it

What it should be

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 6 of 7, Motif

The one recurring detail.

On the site today (seen by eye)

Razor-blade outline around the logo; scrolling ticker

Your decision

☐ Keep what is there ☐ Change it

What it should be

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Part 3: look 7 of 7, Signature

The one moment of motion, or none.

On the site today (seen by eye)

A ticker and a scroll progress line across the top (motion not judged from stills)

Your decision

☐ Keep what is there ☐ Change it ☐ None: no motion

What it should be

Where it comes from: the logo, the premises, paperwork, the trade or the customers

Why, in your own words, about this client's customer

Sign-off

Decided by

Date

Anything you could not decide, and what you would need to decide it